

Meeting Summary

Meeting Date: July 12, 2026

Participants: Charles Wallner, Myra Mitchell, Darlene Underwood, Valerie Allendorf, Deven Corzine, Michael Hentz.

Executive Summary

The board reviewed operational matters related to dance events, venue issues, finances, outreach, fundraising policy, volunteer management, and long-term event planning. Key discussions centered on the ongoing air-conditioning issue at the venue, scheduling and attendance trends, Meetup marketing effectiveness, volunteer recruitment processes, the Appalachian Culture Festival opportunity, and the 2028 Pigtown Fling budget. Several items were deferred for further discussion due to the need for additional information.

Main Discussion Points

1. Dance Event Operations & Attendance

- Members reviewed feedback from a recent Saturday dance event.
- Attendance was considered strong, including visitors from outside the local area.
- The extended Saturday dance format was viewed positively for attracting dancers traveling from greater distances.
- Several attendees felt the dance break was excessively long (over 30 minutes), contributing to people leaving before the event ended.
- Discussion focused on establishing clearer guidance for callers and bands regarding break timing, with a target of approximately 20 minutes.

2. Venue Air Conditioning Issues

- The board received an update regarding the ongoing HVAC problem.
- The board was informed that the issue will be resolved as soon as possible
- Members discussed the need for consistent communication about the situation without discouraging attendance.

3. Contract and Venue Communications

- Darlene confirmed that contract discussions with the venue have been completed and that all parties have agreed to the terms.
- A final contract was expected for signature shortly.
- The board also discussed clarifying communication channels with venue leadership to prevent duplicated or fragmented communications.

4. ArtsWave Reporting Requirements

- The venue requested participation statistics to support its ArtsWave grant reporting.
- The board discussed responsibility for supplying attendance and participation data.
- Larry was identified as the primary person responsible for providing these statistics, with Valerie as a potential backup. The board will discuss with Larry at a future board meeting.
- Members agreed the data supports the venue's grant-reporting obligations.

5. Fundraising / Sponsorship Policy

- Charles presented a draft fundraising and sponsorship policy.
- Discussion focused on the need for formal policies covering fundraising activities, including events such as Pigtown Fling and possible future external fundraising opportunities.
- Members generally agreed a smaller working group may be needed to refine the draft.
- No final policy decisions were made during this meeting.

6. Meetup Marketing Program

- Michael reported that the Meetup initiative has generated interest and appears to be attracting some new attendees.
- The board acknowledged that measuring success remains difficult because attendee tracking is limited.
- Members noted anecdotal evidence that new dancers have attended events after discovering the group through Meetup.
- Discussion included pricing options and evaluating the program after a longer trial period.

7. Volunteer Recruitment and Procedures

- The board discussed ways to increase volunteer participation.
- Members supported developing simple checklists for event openers and closers.
- There was discussion about making responsibilities more transparent and highlighting incentives such as free admission.
- A decision on revised volunteer procedures was postponed pending additional input from Philip.

8. Appalachian Culture Festival Opportunity

- The organization was invited to participate in the Appalachian Culture Festival on August 23.
- Very few details had been provided by the organizers.
- Members discussed possible participation formats but determined there was insufficient information to make decisions.
- Valerie and Charles agreed to continue gathering details.

9. Pigtown Fling 2028 Budget Planning

- The board reviewed the proposed 2028 budget.
- Discussion centered on increasing food costs, transportation expenses, airfare inflation, and overall event affordability.
- Concerns were raised about escalating costs and the potential impact on registration pricing and competitiveness with other events.
- Members discussed the need to balance quality programming with financial sustainability.
- The food budget was adjusted upward during discussion to reflect expected inflationary pressures.
- The proposed budget will be updated based on concerns presented by the board and the new budget will be proposed.

Key Decisions

Decision	Outcome
Treasurer's Report	Accepted by the board.
July–December Schedule	Confirmed and considered complete.
Saturday Dance Format	Continue with the extended Saturday dance format; no change approved.
ArtsWave Statistics Reporting	Larry recognized as the primary person responsible for reporting participation statistics. Need to discuss with Larry.
Meetup Program	Approved continuation of Meetup for an additional six-month period beginning after the current term ends. Motion approved and seconded.
Volunteer Procedures	Deferred until a future meeting after additional feedback is gathered.
Appalachian Culture Festival Participation	No decision; awaiting event details.
Fundraising Policy	Deferred for further review and committee work.

Action Items

Action Item	Owner	Due/Timing
Draft guidance on Saturday dance break timing and announcements.	Darlene	Before future Saturday events.
Print and distribute break/announcement timing guidance.	Valerie	After receiving draft from Darlene.
Finalize and sign venue contract.	Darlene / Venue (Omar & Brianna)	Expected within the week.
Continue working with venue regarding air-conditioning resolution and updates.	Darlene / Venue Leadership	Ongoing.
Share participation statistics with ArtsWave through venue reporting process.	Larry (proposed)	Semiannual reporting cycle.
Refine draft fundraising/sponsorship policy and determine committee structure.	Charles and future committee	Future meeting.
Continue monitoring Meetup performance and engagement metrics.	Michael	During next six-month evaluation period.
Gather additional information regarding Appalachian Culture Festival expectations and logistics.	Valerie and Charles	Before August planning decisions.
Revisit volunteer procedures and opener/closer process after Philip's input.	Board / Philip	Next meeting.
Update Pigtown 2028 food budget and continue reviewing cost assumptions.	Pigtown Planning Team (Myra & Valerie)	During ongoing budget planning.

Items Deferred to Future Meetings

- Sponsorship/Fundraising Policy review.
- Outreach opportunities discussion.
- Volunteer procedure updates.
- Appalachian Culture Festival participation decision.
- Further review of Pigtown 2028 financial assumptions and pricing strategy.